Class 54 Reading Homework

Era 19: Early Cold War · Focus: 1950s society · Eisenhower foreign policy

Reading due today: AMSCO 8.4, 8.5

Connect: Eisenhower — a former general — warned about the military establishment's power. Washington in his Farewell (Class 11) warned about permanent alliances and standing armies. What's the American tradition of civilian suspicion of the military?

Learning Objective(s) for today

– **8.4 (LO D):** Explain the causes of economic growth in the years after World War II.
– **8.5 (LO F):** Explain how mass culture has been maintained or challenged over time.

As you read, identify each of the following:

Terms (define in 1–2 sentences)

[ ] Levittown
[ ] suburbanization
[ ] baby boom
[ ] Interstate Highway Act
[ ] Suez Crisis
[ ] Beat Generation

People (name + role/significance in 1 sentence)

[ ] D. Eisenhower
[ ] N. Khrushchev
[ ] J. Kerouac

Events (year + one-sentence significance)

[ ] GI Bill (1944)
[ ] Interstate Hwy Act (1956)
[ ] Sputnik (1957)
[ ] U-2 Incident (1960)

Reading Focus Questions

Answer in 2–4 complete sentences each. Use specific evidence from the reading.

1. Explain the 'postwar consensus' on economic policy: what shared assumptions did Democrats and Republicans hold from 1945 to 1968?

2. How did the interstate highway system (1956), suburbs, and Levittown reshape American life?

3. What did Eisenhower mean by 'military-industrial complex,' and why did he warn about it in 1961?